## Introduction

An Arabic verb must contain the following two components:

1. فِعْلٌ: the verb
2. ضَمِيْرٌ: the pronoun: the person, gender, and number of the one carrying out the action

For example, the verb فَعَلْتُمْ consists of a verb and a subject pronoun.

| | |
|---|---|
| تُمْ | فَعَلْ |
| Pronoun | Verb |

The pronoun attached to the verb can be changed into different forms to show different person, gender, and number. This change is called conjugation, تَصْرِيْفٌ.

### Person

There are three types of persons:

1. Third person, i.e., he, she, or they. In Arabic, this is called غَائِبٌ; the person being spoken about.
2. Second person, i.e., you. In Arabic, this is called مُخَاطَبٌ; the addressee.
3. First person, i.e., I or we. In Arabic this is called مُتَكَلِّمٌ; the person speaking about themselves.

### Gender

In Arabic, there are two genders:

1. Masculine, مُذَكَّرٌ.
2. Feminine, مُؤَنَّثٌ.

### Number

There are three numbers:

1. Singular, مُفْرَدٌ.
2. Dual, مُثَنًّى.
3. Plural, جَمْعٌ.

## Conjugation

A verb can be conjugated into different forms to reflect different types of pronouns.

Each form of the verb with the pronoun is known as a صِيْغَةٌ. Its plural is صِيَغٌ.

The first person, الْمُتَكَلِّمُ, does not have a dual and it is shared for both masculine and feminine. As a result, there are only 14 صِيَغٌ, not 18.

The name of each صِيْغَةٌ along with its translation and explanation is given below. It is important to memorise the name of all the صِيَغٌ.

| English | Number | Gender | Person | صِيْغَةٌ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| He/It | Singular | Masculine | Third Person | الْغَائِبُ |
| They (m/d) | Dual | | | الْغَائِبَانِ |
| They (m/p) | Plural | | | الْغَائِبُوْنَ |
| She/It | Singular | Feminine | Third Person | الْغَائِبَةُ |
| They (f/d) | Dual | | | الْغَائِبَتَانِ |
| They (f/p) | Plural | | | الْغَائِبَاتُ |
| You (m/s) | Singular | Masculine | Second Person | الْمُخَاطَبُ |
| You (m/d) | Dual | | | الْمُخَاطَبَانِ |
| You (m/p) | Plural | | | الْمُخَاطَبُوْنَ |
| You (f/s) | Singular | Feminine | Second Person | الْمُخَاطَبَةُ |
| You (f/d) | Dual | | | الْمُخَاطَبَتَانِ |
| You (f/p) | Plural | | | الْمُخَاطَبَاتُ |
| I | Singular | Masculine/ Feminine | First Person | الْمُتَكَلِّمُ |
| We | Dual/Plural | | | الْمُتَكَلِّمُوْنَ |

## Part 1: الْمَاضِيْ

In Arabic, the past tense verb is called الْمَاضِيْ.

فَتَحَ زَيْدٌ

*Zaid opened*

### Types of Pronouns

There are of two types of pronouns:

1. ضَمِيْرٌ مُسْتَتِرٌ: pronouns within the verb
2. ضَمِيْرٌ بَارِزٌ: pronouns attached to the verb

### Pronouns with الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِيْ

In the conjugation of الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِيْ, two صِيْغَةٌ have a ضَمِيْرٌ مُسْتَتِرٌ; the صِيْغَةٌ of الْغَائِبُ and الْغَائِبَةُ.

جَلَسَ (هُوَ)　　جَلَسَتْ (هِيَ)

In these verbs, the subject pronouns are hidden i.e., هُوَ (he) and هِيَ (she).

In the remaining صِيَغٌ, the pronouns are visible

جَلَسْتُ (تُ)، جَلَسْنَا (نَا)

In these verbs, ـتُ (I) and ـنَا (We) can be seen at the end of the verb.

### 📖Note

The ت at the end of الْغَائِبَةُ and الْغَائِبَتَانِ is a sign to indicate the verb is feminine, it is not a pronoun.

جَلَسَتْ، جَلَسَتَا

## Part 2: الْمُضَارِعُ

In Arabic, the word الْمُضَارِعُ is used to denote two tenses:

1. Present Tense: In Arabic this is known as حَالٌ.

   There are two types of present tense:
   Present habitual: an action that takes place regularly

   *Zaid walks.*

   Present continuous: an action that is taking place right now

   *Zaid is walking.*

2. Future Tense: In Arabic this is known as مُسْتَقْبِلٌ.

   *Zaid will walk.*

The context of the sentence or paragraph will help determine which tense is being referred to.

### Understanding the صِيَغٌ of الْمُضَارِعُ

Each صِيْغَةٌ of الْمُضَارِعُ is made up of four components:

1. the verb, فِعْلٌ
2. the pronoun, ضَمِيْرٌ
3. the حَرْفُ الْمُضَارِعِ, the letter which precedes الْمُضَارِعِ
   These are أ ,ت ,ي or ن. A mnemonic for these is نَأْتِيْ
4. عَلَامَةُ الْإِعْرَابِ, a حَرَكَةٌ or letter which indicates the state of the verb. (This will be discussed later)

The table below shows the components of الْمُضَارِعُ.

| عَلَامَةُ الْإِعْرَابِ | Pronoun ضَمِيْرٌ | Verb فِعْلٌ | حَرْفُ الْمُضَارِعِ |
|---|---|---|---|
| نَ | ـُوْ | ـْفْتَحُ | يَـ |

In الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعِ, five صِيْغَةٌ have a ضَمِيْرٌ مُسْتَتِرٌ; the صِيْغَةٌ of الْغَائِبُ, الْغَائِبَةُ, الْمُخَاطَبُ, الْمُتَكَلِّمُ and الْمُتَكَلِّمُوْنَ.

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| يَفْتَحُ (هُوَ) | تَفْتَحُ (هِيَ) | تَفْتَحُ (أَنْتَ) | أَفْتَحُ (أَنَا) | نَفْتَحُ (نَحْنُ) |

## Part 4: الْمَجْهُوْلُ

Verbs can be divided into two categories according to its voice.

1) Active Voice: this is a verb in which the subject, is mentioned.

*The thief stole the wealth.*

The active voice is the original form of the verb.

This is called فِعْلٌ مَعْلُوْمٌ فَاعِلُهُ, a verb whose subject is known. It is also shortened and called فِعْلٌ مَعْلُوْمٌ.

2) Passive Voice: this is a verb in which the subject is not mentioned, and the verb is attributed to the direct object.

*The bike was stolen.*

The passive voice is called فِعْلٌ مَجْهُوْلٌ فَاعِلُهُ, a verb whose subject is not mentioned. It is also shortened and called فِعْلٌ مَجْهُوْلٌ.

### Translating الْفِعْلُ الْمَجْهُوْلُ

The passive voice is translated by adding the auxiliary verb to be (was, is, is being, will be) to the past participle of the main verb.

*The bike was [auxiliary verb] stolen [past tense of the main verb].*

The tense is shown in the auxiliary verb, not the main verb, as this remains the same in all tenses.

| Tense | | Active Voice | Passive Voice |
|---|---|---|---|
| الْمَاضِيْ | Past | The thief stole the bike. | The bike was stolen. |
| الْمُضَارِعُ | Present Habitual | The thief steals the bike. | The bike is stolen. |
| | Present Continuous | The thief is stealing the bike. | The bike is being stolen. |
| | Future | The thief will steal the bike. | The bike will be stolen. |

In these examples, the past participle of the verb to steal, stolen, is used with all the tenses. The auxiliary verb is used in different tenses to show the tense of the main verb.

## الْمَاضِي الْمَجْهُوْلُ

The passive of الْمَاضِيْ is formed by:

1. Leaving the harakah of the last letter as it is
2. Giving the penultimate letter a كَسْرَةٌ
3. Giving the remaining letters a ضَمَّةٌ

| الْمَاضِي الْمَعْلُوْمُ | ① | ② | ③ |
|---|---|---|---|
| بَعَثَ | بعثَ | بعِثَ | بُعِثَ |

**Note**

1. الْفِعْلُ الْمَجْهُوْلُ is formed in the same way for all the أَبْوَابٌ.

| الْمَاضِي الْمَجْهُوْلُ | فَتَحَ يَفْتَحُ | سَمِعَ يَسْمَعُ | ضَرَبَ يَضْرِبُ | نَصَرَ يَنْصُرُ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | فُتِحَ | سُمِعَ | ضُرِبَ | نُصِرَ |

2. Verbs from بَاب كَرُمَ يَكْرُمُ do not occur in the مَجْهُوْلٌ form.

## Part 6: نَفْيُ الْفِعْل

Verbs are either affirmative or negative.
An affirmative verb is one that shows that the action took place. This is called مُثْبَتٌ.

*Zaid sat.*

A negative verb is one that shows that the action did not take place. This is called مَنْفِيٌّ.

*Zaid did not sit.*

A verb is مَنْفِيٌّ when it is preceded by a حَرْفُ نَفْيٍ, a negative particle. A verb without such a particle will be مُثْبَتٌ.

### Negative Particles

There are various particles to make a verb negative.

### Negative Particles for الْمَاضِيْ

الْمَاضِيْ is made negative by adding the particle مَا at the beginning.

مَا ذَهَبَ زَيْدٌ

*Zaid did not go.*

### Exercise 1

Make the following verbs negative and then translate.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ١) بَعَثْنَّ | ٤) رُفِعْتُمَا | ٧) سَحَرَتَا | ١٠) فَتَحْتُ |
| ٢) جَعَلْتِ | ٥) رَكَعْتَ | ٨) سَمِعْنَا | ١١) قَرَؤُوْا |
| ٣) ذَهَبْتُمْ | ٦) سُأَلْنَ | ٩) صَلَحَتْ | ١٢) لُعِنَا |

## Negative Particles for الْمُضَارِعُ

الْمُضَارِعُ is made مَنْفِيٌّ by adding any of the following particles:

1. لَمْ: This gives الْمُضَارِعُ a negative meaning in the past tense.

| |
|---|
| لَمْ يَذْهَبْ زَيْدٌ |
| *Zaid did not go.* |

The فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ after لَمْ will be in the مَجْزُوْمٌ state.

2. مَا: This gives الْمُضَارِعُ a negative meaning in the present tense, habitual or continuous.

| Present Habitual | Present Continuous |
|---|---|
| مَا يَذْهَبُ زَيْدٌ | |
| Zaid does not go. | Zaid is not going. |

3. لَا: This gives الْمُضَارِعُ a negative meaning in the present habitual, present continuous, or future tense.

| Present Habitual | Present Continuous | Future |
|---|---|---|
| لَا يَذْهَبُ زَيْدٌ | | |
| Zaid does not go. | Zaid is not going. | Zaid will not go. |

4. لَنْ: This gives الْمُضَارِعُ an emphatic negative meaning in the future tense.

| |
|---|
| لَنْ يَّذْهَبَ زَيْدٌ |
| *Zaid will not go.* |

The فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ after لَنْ will be in the مَنْصُوْبٌ state.

### Exercise 2

Translate the following. If there is more than one possible translation, mention all of them.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ١) لَمْ يَحْزَنْ | ٤) لَنْ تَسْخَرَ | ٧) لَمْ تُحْفَظُوْا | ١٠) مَا نُرْحَمُ |
| ٢) لَا يَرْكَبَانِ | ٥) لَا تَشْهَدَانِ | ٨) لَنْ تَعْلَمِيْ | ١١) لَمْ يُكْرَهْ |
| ٣) مَا يَحْزَنُوْنَ | ٦) مَا يَلْبَثْنَ | ٩) لَا تَعْمَلْنَ | ١٢) لَا يُحْمَلَانِ |

## Part 7: الْأَمْرُ and النَّهْيُ

### الأَمْرُ

الْأَمْرُ is the imperative tense used to issue a command.

اِصْبِرْ
*Be patient*

الْأَمْرُ is made from الْمُضَارِعُ. However, since you can only directly command someone who is in front of you, الْأَمْرُ only occurs with the صِيَغُ of مُخَاطَبٌ.

This is formed by:

1. Removing the حَرْفُ الْمُضَارِعِ
2. Adding a temporary hamzah, هَمْزَةُ الْوَصْلِ, at the beginning
3. Making the verb مَجْزُوْمٌ

| ③ | | ② | | ① | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| اِفْعَلْ | ⟵ | فْعَلْ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلْ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلُ |
| اِفْعَلَا | ⟵ | فْعَلَا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلَا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلَانِ |
| اِفْعَلُوْا | ⟵ | فْعَلُوْا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلُوْا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلُوْنَ |
| اِفْعَلِيْ | ⟵ | فْعَلِيْ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلِيْ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلِيْنَ |
| اِفْعَلَا | ⟵ | فْعَلَا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلَا | ⟵ | تَفْعَلَانِ |
| اِفْعَلْنَ | ⟵ | فْعَلْنَ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلْنَ | ⟵ | تَفْعَلْنَ |

### Notes

1. The هَمْزَةُ الْوَصْلِ placed at the beginning of الْأَمْرُ will carry a كَسْرَةٌ unless the عَيْنُ الْكَلِمَةِ of the مُضَارِعٌ has a ضَمَّةٌ. In that case the هَمْزَةُ الْوَصْلِ will have a ضَمَّةٌ.

اُنْصُرْ　　اِصْبِرْ　　اِفْتَحْ

## Part 8: اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ and اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ

Some أَسْمَاءٌ are derived from the مَصْدَرٌ. These derived nouns are called مُشْتَقٌّ.

In this unit, we will cover the following مُشْتَقَّاتٌ.

1. اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ
2. اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ

### اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ

#### Constructing the اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ

The اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ, the active participle, is formed by placing the letters of الْمَاضِيْ in the pattern of فَاعِلٌ.

رَزَقَ يَرْزُقُ رِزْقًا

رَازِقٌ

*provider*

*one who provides*

The dual, plural, and feminine forms are given below:

| Translation | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | صِيْغَةٌ |
|---|---|---|
| Doing, doer, the one who does (m/s) | فَاعِلٌ | الْمُفْرَدُ |
| Doing, doers, those who do (m/d) | فَاعِلَانِ | الْمُثَنَّى |
| Doing, doers, those who do (m/p) | فَاعِلُوْنَ | جَمْعُ الْمُذَكَّرِ |
| Doing, doer, the one who does (f/s) | فَاعِلَةٌ | الْمُفْرَدَةُ |
| Doing, doers, those who do (f/d) | فَاعِلَتَانِ | الْمُثَنَّاةُ |
| Doing, doers, those who do (f/p) | فَاعِلَاتٌ | جَمْعُ الْمُؤَنَّثِ |

## Constructing the اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ

The اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ, the passive participle, is formed by placing the letters of الْمَاضِيْ in the pattern of مَفْعُوْلٌ.

رَزَقَ يَرْزُقُ رِزْقًا

مَرْزُوْقٌ

*provided*

*one who is provided*

The dual, plural, and feminine forms are given below:

| صِيْغَةٌ | اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ | Translation |
|---|---|---|
| الْمُفْرَدُ | مَفْعُوْلٌ | the one which is done (m/s) |
| الْمُثَنَّى | مَفْعُوْلَانِ | those which are done (m/d) |
| جَمْعُ الْمُذَكَّرِ | مَفْعُوْلُوْنَ | those which are done (m/p) |
| الْمُفْرَدَةُ | مَفْعُوْلَةٌ | the one which is done (f/s) |
| الْمُثَنَّاةُ | مَفْعُوْلَتَانِ | those which are done (f/d) |
| جَمْعُ الْمُؤَنَّثِ | مَفْعُوْلَاتٌ | those which are done (f/p) |

### Exercise 4

Practice verbally conjugating the following اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ. Thereafter, fill in the table below.

| صِيْغَةٌ | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| الْمُفْرَدُ | بَالِغٌ | عَابِدٌ | ذَاكِرٌ | رَازِقٌ |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

## Part 9: التَّصْرِيْفُ الصَّغِيْرُ

We have now discussed the تَصْرِيْفٌ of a single verb.

There is another تَصْرِيْفٌ called التَّصْرِيْفُ الصَّغِيْرُ. This is made up of the first word of each of the main تَصَارِيْفُ.

The purpose of learning the التَّصْرِيْفُ الصَّغِيْرُ is to help a student to quickly identify and conjugate the various forms of the verb.

| الْمَاضِي الْمَعْلُوْمُ | الْمُضَارِعُ الْمَعْلُوْمُ | الْمَصْدَرُ | الْمَاضِي الْمَجْهُوْلُ | الْمُضَارِعُ الْمَجْهُوْلُ | الْمَصْدَرُ | الْأَمْرُ | النَّهْيُ | اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| فَتَحَ | يَفْتَحُ | فَتْحًا | فُتِحَ | يُفْتَحُ | فَتْحًا | اِفْتَحْ | لَا تَفْتَحْ | فَاتِحٌ | مَفْتُوْحٌ |
| سَمِعَ | يَسْمَعُ | سَمْعًا | سُمِعَ | يُسْمَعُ | سَمْعًا | اِسْمَعْ | لَا تَسْمَعْ | سَامِعٌ | مَسْمُوْعٌ |
| ضَرَبَ | يَضْرِبُ | ضَرْبًا | ضُرِبَ | يُضْرَبُ | ضَرْبًا | اِضْرِبْ | لَا تَضْرِبْ | ضَارِبٌ | مَضْرُوْبٌ |
| نَصَرَ | يَنْصُرُ | نَصْرًا | نُصِرَ | يُنْصَرُ | نَصْرًا | اُنْصُرْ | لَا تَنْصُرْ | نَاصِرٌ | مَنْصُوْرٌ |
| كَرُمَ | يَكْرُمُ | كَرَامَةً | | | | اُكْرُمْ | لَا تَكْرُمْ | كَرِيْمٌ | |
| حَسِبَ | يَحْسِبُ | حِسْبَانًا | حُسِبَ | يُحْسَبُ | حِسْبَانًا | اِحْسِبْ | لَاتَحْسِبْ | حَاسِبٌ | مَحْسُوْبٌ |

### Exercise 1

Fill in the table below by completing the تَصْرِيْفٌ صَغِيْرٌ of the following مَصْدَر.

| الْمَاضِي الْمَعْلُوْمُ | الْمُضَارِعُ الْمَعْلُوْمُ | الْمَصْدَرُ | الْمَاضِي الْمَجْهُوْلُ | الْمُضَارِعُ الْمَجْهُوْلُ | الْمَصْدَرُ | الْأَمْرُ | النَّهْيُ | اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | بَعْثًا | | | | | | | |
| | | رَحْمَةً | | | | | | | |
| | | صَبْرًا | | | | | | | |
| | | تَرْكًا | | | | | | | |
| | | كِبَرًا | | | | | | | |

# Summary

## Key Terms

Below are the key terms discussed in this section. They are listed according to the order of occurrence.

| English | Arabic | English | Arabic |
|---|---|---|---|
| The third letter of الْمَاضِيْ | لَامُ الْكَلِمَةِ | Conjugation | تَصْرِيْفٌ |
| Active voice | فِعْلٌ مَعْلُوْمٌ فَاعِلُهُ | Verb form | صِيْغَةٌ |
| Passive voice | فِعْلٌ مَجْهُوْلٌ فَاعِلُهُ | Masculine | مُذَكَّرٌ |
| Grammatical state | إِعْرَابٌ | Feminine | مُؤَنَّثٌ |
| Non-declinable | مَبْنِيٌّ | Singular | مُفْرَدٌ |
| Declinable | مُعْرَبٌ | Dual | مُثَنًّى |
| Sign of grammatical state | عَلَامَةُ الْإِعْرَابِ | Plural | جَمْعٌ |
| Default state of a verb | مَرْفُوْعٌ | Third person | غَائِبٌ |
| State of a verb (preceded by لَنْ) | مَنْصُوْبٌ | Second person | مُخَاطَبٌ |
| State of a verb (preceded by لَمْ) | مَجْزُوْمٌ | First person | مُتَكَلِّمٌ |
| A particle which makes the following verb مَنْصُوْبٌ | حَرْفٌ نَاصِبٌ | Past tense | مَاضٍ |
| A particle which makes the following verb مَجْزُوْمٌ | حَرْفٌ جَازِمٌ | Pronoun | ضَمِيْرٌ |
| نُوْنٌ Which is a pronoun | نُوْنُ النِّسْوَةِ | Hidden pronoun | مُسْتَتِرٌ |
| نُوْنٌ Which shows that the verb is مَرْفُوْعٌ | نُوْنُ الْإِعْرَابِ | Visible pronoun | بَارِزٌ |
| Affirmative | مُثْبَتٌ | Present and Future Tense | مُضَارِعٌ |
| Negative | مَنْفِيٌّ | Present | حَالٌ |
| Negative particle | حَرْفُ نَفْيٍ | Future | مُسْتَقْبِلٌ |
| Active participle | اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ | Letters which precede a فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ | حُرُوْفُ الْمُضَارِعِ |
| Passive participle | اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ | Combinations of الْمَاضِيْ and الْمُضَارِعُ | بَابٌ (أَبْوَابٌ) |
| | التَّصْرِيْفُ الصَّغِيْرُ | The first letter of الْمَاضِيْ | فَاءُ الْكَلِمَةِ |
| | التَّصْرِيْفُ الْكَبِيْرُ | The second letter of الْمَاضِيْ | عَيْنُ الْكَلِمَةِ |